UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION (UPSC)

CDS GENERAL KNOWLEDGE — SUBJECT 2: INDIAN HISTORY & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

OFFICIAL MASTER ANSWER KEY & COMPREHENSIVE EXPLANATIONS

Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans
1	(C)	6	(A)	11	(C)	16	(C)	21	(B)	26	(B)
2	(B)	7	(B)	12	(C)	17	(A)	22	(A)	27	(B)
3	(A)	8	(A)	13	(C)	18	(A)	23	(C)	28	(D)
4	(A)	9	(A)	14	(A)	19	(A)	24	(A)	29	(A)
5	(D)	10	(A)	15	(A)	20	(C)	25	(A)	30	(A)

COMPREHENSIVE CONCEPTUAL SOLUTIONS & RATIONALES:

Q.1 — Official Correct Answer: (C) 2 and 3 only

Question: Britain and France French attempt for a no-fly zone could not reach consensus United Nations has been non- supportive for any kind of action against Libya
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.2 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Winston Churchill

Question: Consider the following statement : “A sound body means one which bends itself to the spirit and is always a ready instrument at its service.” The above statement is attributed to
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.3 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Debendranath Tagore and Keshab Chandra Sen

Question: Following the first schism in the Brahmo Samaj in 1866, who were the leaders of the two factions (Adi Brahmo Samaj and Brahmo Samaj of India) respectively?
Solution Rationale: In 1866, the Brahmo Samaj split into the conservative 'Adi Brahmo Samaj' led by Debendranath Tagore and the reformist 'Brahmo Samaj of India' led by Keshab Chandra Sen.

Q.4 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Jallianwala Bagh massacre in Amritsar

Question: Rabindranath Tagore renounced his British Knighthood in May 1919 in protest against which of the following atrocities?
Solution Rationale: Rabindranath Tagore wrote an impassioned letter to Viceroy Lord Chelmsford repudiating his Knighthood following the brutal Jallianwala Bagh massacre of innocent Indians on 13 April 1919.

Q.5 — Official Correct Answer: (D) Lord Wavell

Question: The Cabinet Mission arrived in India in 1946.
Solution Rationale: The Cabinet Mission sent by Clement Attlee in March 1946 consisted of three British cabinet ministers: Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, and A.V. Alexander. Lord Wavell was the Viceroy of India, not a Mission member.

Q.6 — Official Correct Answer: (A) R. Ambedkar

Question: The historic Poona Pact of 1932 was signed between Mahatma Gandhi and:
Solution Rationale: The Poona Pact was signed on 24 September 1932 at Yerwada Central Jail between Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, replacing separate electorates for depressed classes with reserved joint electorate seats.

Q.7 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Ryotwari System

Question: Under which one of the following revenue assessment systems introduced by the British was land revenue collected directly from the ryots (cultivators)?
Solution Rationale: The Ryotwari System was introduced by Thomas Munro and Captain Alexander Read in Madras and Bombay Presidencies. Revenue was settled directly with individual cultivators (ryots).

Q.8 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Operation Shakti

Question: Under which operation codename did India conduct a series of five nuclear bomb test explosions at the Pokhran test range in May 1998?
Solution Rationale: Pokhran-II, conducted on 11 and 13 May 1998 under Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, was designated Operation Shakti. (Pokhran-I in 1974 was Operation Smiling Buddha).

Q.9 — Official Correct Answer: (A) The Five Friendlies representing natural elements and Olympic rings

Question: What does 'Fuwa', the Official Mascot of the 2008 Olympic Games in Beijing, represent?
Solution Rationale: Fuwa (literally 'good-luck dolls') were the mascots of the 2008 Beijing Olympics, designed to embody the Olympic rings and Chinese natural elements (Beibei, Jingjing, Huanhuan, Yingying, Nini).

Q.10 — Official Correct Answer: (A) 1 — 2 — 3 — 4

Question: What is the correct chronological sequence of the following historic events in the Indian national movement? 1. Non-Cooperation Movement 2. Simon Commission in India 3. Poona Pact 4. Quit India Movement Select the correct answer using the code given below:
Solution Rationale: Non-Cooperation Movement (1920), Simon Commission arrival (1928), Poona Pact between Gandhi and Ambedkar (1932), Quit India Movement (1942).

Q.11 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Wamen Hastings

Question: Which British Military Officer defeated Tipu Sultan in India, Napolean Bonaparte in Europe arid eventually became the Duke of Wellington ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian History & Freedom Struggle).

Q.12 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Third Buddhist Council

Question: Which Buddhist Council was convened during the reign of King Ashoka at Pataliputra?
Solution Rationale: The Third Buddhist Council was convened in 250 BCE at Pataliputra under the patronage of Emperor Ashoka and presided over by Moggaliputta Tissa. The Abhidhamma Pitaka was compiled here.

Q.13 — Official Correct Answer: (C) They were acquainted with the cow. which formed the most important form of wealth

Question: Which One among the following is not a characteristic Of Rig-Vedic Aryans ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian History & Freedom Struggle).

Q.14 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Lord Curzon's Partition of Bengal

Question: Which among the following was the most immediate catalyst for the nationwide spread of the Swadeshi and Boycott Movement in 1905?
Solution Rationale: Lord Curzon announced the Partition of Bengal in July 1905 and implemented it on 16 October 1905, triggering the anti-partition Swadeshi and Boycott movement.

Q.15 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Kalibangan

Question: Which of the following Harappan sites has provided evidence of a ploughed field?
Solution Rationale: Evidence of a ploughed field with criss-cross furrows was discovered at Kalibangan (Rajasthan). Lothal is famous for its tidal dockyard; Dholavira for water harvesting.

Q.16 — Official Correct Answer: (C) In Gandhian movements, disciplined organizational leadership played no significant role

Question: Which of the following statements regarding Gandhian mass movements is not correct?
Solution Rationale: Statement (c) is incorrect. Centralized, disciplined leadership and strict moral command were vital hallmarks of all Gandhian campaigns (Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India).

Q.17 — Official Correct Answer: (A) He emphasized devotion to One Formless God (Nirguna/Ik Onkar) and rejected caste hierarchies and empty ritualism

Question: Which of the following statements regarding the spiritual teachings of Guru Nanak Dev, the first Sikh Guru, is correct?
Solution Rationale: Guru Nanak emphasized universal love, honest labor (Kirat Karo), sharing with others (Vand Chhako), and meditation on the Divine Name (Naam Japna) while rejecting caste prejudices.

Q.18 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Battle of Wandiwash

Question: Which of the following was the decisive battle in 1760 in which the British forces commanded by Sir Eyre Coote decisively defeated the French under Count de Lally during the Third Carnatic War?
Solution Rationale: The Battle of Wandiwash (22 January 1760) ended French military influence in India and cemented British commercial and political hegemony.

Q.19 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Lahore Session (1929)

Question: Which one among the following was the historic session of the Indian National Congress where the resolution for 'Purna Swaraj' (Complete Independence) was adopted?
Solution Rationale: At the historic Lahore Session in December 1929, under the presidency of Jawaharlal Nehru, the Indian National Congress adopted the Purna Swaraj resolution declaring complete independence as its ultimate goal.

Q.20 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Late preparation for the defence Of Delhi

Question: Which one among the following was not a possible reaSon for •the success of Nadir Shah's military campaign in Delhi ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.21 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Hunter Committee (Disorders Inquiry Committee)

Question: Which one of the following Commissions was appointed by the British Government to investigate the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919)?
Solution Rationale: The Hunter Committee (Disorders Inquiry Committee), headed by Lord William Hunter, was appointed in October 1919 to investigate the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in Amritsar.

Q.22 — Official Correct Answer: (A) 1, 2 and

Question: Which one of the following inscriptions mentions Pulakesin II's military success against Harsh avardhana?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.23 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Mirage-2000 is a multi-role fighter of French origin

Question: Which one of the following statements with respect to Indian Air Force is not correct ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.24 — Official Correct Answer: (A) It was built by Chola Emperor Rajaraja I in the 11th century

Question: Which one of the following statements regarding the Brihadeeswara Temple at Thanjavur is correct?
Solution Rationale: Brihadeeswara Temple (Peruvudaiyar Kovil) is a grand Dravidian granite temple dedicated to Lord Shiva, completed in 1010 CE by Rajaraja Chola I.

Q.25 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Padayani

Question: Which one of the following traditional dance forms is a ritualistic folk dance involving masks made of arecanut spathe, performed in the temples of Central and Southern Kerala?
Solution Rationale: Padayani (or Padeni) is an ancient ritualistic folk theater and mask dance performed in Bhadrakali temples of Central Travancore, Kerala.

Q.26 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Mahatma Gandhi

Question: Who among the following was elected as the President of the All-India Khilafat Conference met at Delhi in November 1919?
Solution Rationale: Mahatma Gandhi was elected President of the All-India Khilafat Conference in Delhi in November 1919. He saw the Khilafat movement as a prime opportunity to unite Hindus and Muslims in the national struggle.

Q.27 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Kunwar Singh

Question: Who among the following led the 1857 Revolt in Bihar?
Solution Rationale: Veer Kunwar Singh of Jagdishpur (Arrah, Bihar) led the 1857 Revolt in Bihar with exceptional guerrilla warfare tactics at the age of nearly 80.

Q.28 — Official Correct Answer: (D) Siraj-ud-Daulah (Nawab of Bengal)

Question: Who among the following was not a party to the tripartite confederacy that fought against the British East India Company in the Battle of Buxar (1764)?
Solution Rationale: Siraj-ud-Daulah fought in the Battle of Plassey (1757) and was killed soon after. The Battle of Buxar (1764) was fought between Hector Munro and the combined forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula, and Shah Alam II.

Q.29 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Lord Dalhousie

Question: Who among the following Governors-General of India created the Public Works Department (PWD) and introduced electric telegraph and railways in India?
Solution Rationale: Lord Dalhousie (1848–1856) created the separate Public Works Department (PWD), introduced the first passenger railway (1853, Bombay to Thane), electric telegraph lines, and modern postal system.

Q.30 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Allama Muhammad Iqbal

Question: Who among the following eminent Urdu poets and scholars was invited to attend both the Second and Third Round Table Conferences in London?
Solution Rationale: Sir Allama Muhammad Iqbal attended the Second (1931) and Third (1932) Round Table Conferences in London.